

Setting up site analytics

Add analytics to understand how readers use your documentation.

Google Analytics 4 (built-in)

DocsForge ships with a built-in Google Analytics 4 integration.

```
extra:
  analytics:
    provider: google
    property: G-XXXXXXXXXX # Your Measurement ID
```

Other providers

For Plausible, Fathom, GoatCounter, Umami, or any other provider, add the tracking script via

`extra_javascript`:

```
extra_javascript:
  - assets/javascripts/analytics.js
```

docs/assets/javascripts/analytics.js

```
// Your custom analytics initialization
```

Privacy considerations

DocsForge is designed with privacy in mind:

- Search is client-side (no search data leaves the browser)
- No external fonts are loaded by default (all vendored)
- No external JavaScript except what you explicitly add
- Works fully offline with no network requests

If you add analytics, consider:

- Using privacy-focused providers (Plausible, Fathom, GoatCounter)
- Adding a privacy policy if required by your jurisdiction
- Respecting Do Not Track signals

Disabling analytics in development

The DocsForge development server (`docsforge serve`) does not include analytics scripts. They are only added during production builds.

Next steps

- [Setting up social cards](#)
- [Building an optimized site](#)

Tracking events

Track custom events (e.g., button clicks, downloads) by adding JavaScript:

docs/assets/javascripts/events.js

```
document.addEventListener('click', function(e) {  
  if (e.target.matches('a[href*=".zip"]')) {  
    // Track download  
    gtag('event', 'download', {  
      event_category: 'documentation',  
      event_label: e.target.href  
    });  
  }  
});
```

Best practices

- Use privacy-focused analytics when possible
- Only track what's necessary for improving docs
- Document your analytics practices in a privacy policy
- Respect user preferences (Do Not Track, GDPR consent)
- Test analytics in production builds, not development
- Regularly review analytics data to identify popular and underused pages

Troubleshooting

Analytics not loading

1. Check that `property` is set correctly
2. Verify you're viewing a production build, not `docsforge serve`

3. Check browser console for JavaScript errors
4. Ensure ad blockers aren't blocking the tracking script

Data not appearing

1. Analytics dashboards may have a delay (up to 24 hours for some providers)
2. Verify the correct property ID is configured
3. Check that the site is publicly accessible (analytics can't track localhost)

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